Ysbyty Gwynedd
Anaesthetics Department
Adran Anaestheteg

OPERATIONAL POLICIES

YG OPG 013 MAR 2023

Admission of Day Case Patients

REVIEW BY DECEMBER 2025

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Key Points

- Ensure patients meet criteria to be a day case
- If a patient doesn't reach the discharge criteria the surgical and anaesthetic teams should be informed and the patient's responsible adult contacted

Background

Patients will be contacted the day before admission to ensure they qualify as day-cases.

Every morning, when the hospital safety huddle meeting occurs estimates will be made of the predicted number of in-patient beds required. Representatives from all departments and the Bed Manager are present. The previous day's cancellations and other occupancy data will also be discussed. An assessment is made of the likely number of day-cases that may need in-patient admission.

Patients are discharged from the Day Surgical Ward (Tudno) by nurse led criteria as per document:

"CRITERIA FOR NURSE LED DISCHARGE ON TUDNO WARD – SHORT STAY SURGICAL PATIENTS"

Patients not reaching these criteria are admitted as in-patients.

Admission Process

1. The patient's nominated nurse will inform the Ward Sister that the patient requires admission.
2. The Sister will contact the appropriate ward and request a bed.
3. If there is no bed available the Sister will contact the Bed Manager (Bleep 021) who will organise an appropriate bed.
4. The Tudno Ward Sister will inform the Anaesthetic and Surgical Team which ward the patient is being transferred to and why.
5. The Surgical team will clerk the patient and manage the clinical aspect of the admission.
6. The Anaesthetist, or if out of hours the on call anaesthetic team, will give anaesthetic support.

7. The Ward Sister will ensure the Patient Information System is updated with the patient's details.
8. The responsible adult for the patient will be contacted to explain the situation.

Addendum: Paediatric Admission Process

Although this Guideline is for adults the same process would occur for children. However, all day-case children are admitted to Minffordd or Dewi Children's wards. These wards are never full and there is never any issues of bed occupancy so there would be no transfer to a different ward.